FRONT RANGE REGION
Young Life

BOULDER VALLEY · COMMITTEE

Boulder Committee Roles

A guide for new and prospective committee members

Each local Young Life area has a committee of adults who believe in the mission of Young Life: to introduce adolescents to Jesus Christ and to help them grow in their faith. You'll find adults from all different backgrounds, careers and churches, including lots of moms and dads who care deeply about kids.

Committees pray faithfully for kids and for Young Life, plan events like fundraisers and community socials, build relationships across the community, and support the staff and area director. The best and most fulfilling committee work happens outside of the monthly meeting — through these focused subcommittee roles.

Leader Care & Hospitality

Ensures that staff and volunteers receive the care, support and hospitality they need to be effective in the area mission to reach kids.

OVERVIEW

Being a Young Life staff person or a volunteer leader is a rewarding responsibility. However, building friendships with kids in order to earn the right to tell them about Jesus and helping them grow in their faith can be taxing. Therefore, staff and leaders need extra care, support and hospitality. The local committee can have a major role in providing this care.

JOB DESCRIPTION

- Plan and organize the care of local staff and volunteer leaders.
- Develop a subcommittee to assist in this effort.
- Coordinate care involving prayer, befriending, mentoring, spiritual support, office work and assisting with fundraising.
- Note: The committee is primarily responsible for the care of the area director and any other staff. The staff is primarily responsible for the care of volunteer leaders.

Basic Strategies to Develop

Develop two levels of leader care:

- **Area-Wide Leader Care:** Plan and organize three area-wide events to care for staff and volunteer leaders each year. Possibilities include a beginning-of-the-year welcome picnic, a Christmas meal with a white elephant exchange, and an end-of-year thank you dinner with an appreciation gift.
- **Individual Leader Care:** Collect information from area staff and volunteer leaders about their needs and distribute that information to a committee member or parent partner who provides personal support throughout the year. Periodically monitor committee members to ensure each is actively caring for their assigned staff member or volunteer leader.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Excellent organizational skills.
- Is creative.
- Is proactive.
- Possesses the gifts of hospitality, exhortation and encouragement.

Prayer Team

Collects prayer requests from the local area staff and volunteers and prays together on a regular basis.

OVERVIEW

Being a Young Life staff person or a volunteer leader is a rewarding responsibility. However, building friendships with kids in order to earn the right to tell them about Jesus makes staff and leaders more susceptible to spiritual warfare. Therefore, staff and leaders need extra care and support. The local committee can have a major role in providing this care through prayer.

JOB DESCRIPTION

- On a consistent basis, collect prayer requests from the local area staff and distribute those requests to several different groups.

Basic Strategies to Develop

Develop three layers of prayer strategy for the area:

- **Area-Wide Prayer Strategy:** Involve as many people as possible from inside and outside the area who will pray for the Young Life ministry. Obtain general prayer requests from the area director monthly. Develop an e-mail distribution list drawing from committee, donors, church prayer groups, volunteer leaders, staff, banquet list, and others.
- **Committee-Wide Prayer Strategy:** The committee should pray as a group for staff, volunteer leaders, and donors about key issues related to the ministry. Make prayer an important part of the committee meeting — consider an hour of prayer before the meeting or a weekly lunch gathering.
- **Individual Prayer Strategy:** Each committee member should be paired with a specific staff member or volunteer leader to pray specifically for them. The committee member solicits individual prayer requests from their assigned person.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Understands the power of prayer.
- Has the gift of prayer.
- Is able to elicit the needs and concerns of others.
- Good listening skills.
- Can organize.

Events

Plans and executes fundraising events (banquet, golf tournament) in cooperation with staff and volunteers to raise financial support for the area.

OVERVIEW

Young Life exists in an area because the community is willing to financially support the ministry. Events such as the banquet and golf tournament are important each year. The banquet serves to celebrate, inform, proclaim the Gospel, affirm, give thanks and raise financial support. The golf tournament is a fun way to engage new participants while raising financial support. These events should be an important part of the area's overall Taking Donors Seriously (TDS) strategy.

JOB DESCRIPTION

- Oversee all aspects of area events by providing leadership and direction to staff and other event volunteers.
- Delegate and follow up with event participants: table hosts, hole sponsors, corporate sponsors, caterers, decorations, registration, name tags, program, and follow up.

Basic Strategies to Develop

Young Life has developed “The 10 Essentials” for a successful event:

- Determine the right type of event.
- Set date, time and place of event.
- Reserve event location.

- Delegate committee assignments.
- Recruit table (banquet) or hole (golf) hosts.
- Generate a guest list.
- Invite guests.
- Make table seating (banquet) or foursome (golf) assignments.
- Plan program.
- Conduct event follow up.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Excellent organizational and project management abilities.
- Is comfortable with multi-tasking.
- Can delegate and hold others accountable.
- Possesses the gifts of hospitality and leadership.

Resource Development

Engages with local community groups and businesses to develop partnerships and drive forward the area's strategic vision.

OVERVIEW

The members of the local community should be aware of and informed about the ministry of Young Life. By fostering relationships with local businesses, Young Life's mission can be more fully communicated to the general public. By having a clear understanding of the ministry and its activities, Young Life can develop partnerships with and support from local community groups and businesses.

JOB DESCRIPTION

- Work closely with the area director to ensure that all significant Young Life activities and events are publicized in a timely manner.
- Identify and engage potential local businesses to create partnerships and possibly expand the business donor base.
- Regularly communicate and collaborate with the Donor Care Specialist and Event Coordinator to create compelling marketing or partnership materials for the community.
- Ensure that events are publicized in area newspapers, print and radio (as appropriate).
- Ensure that the Young Life area is represented at community events and networking functions.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Experienced in business relations and/or journalism.
- Strong written and verbal skills.
- Excellent organizational skills.

Ministry Admin Support

Helps the area director stay on top of the administrative side of the ministry, so more of their time goes to kids, leaders and the Boulder community.

OVERVIEW

Our area director carries a lot: building relationships with kids across Boulder, training and caring for volunteer leaders, meeting with donors, partnering with the committee and reporting to the region. Behind all of that is a steady stream of calendars, deadlines, reports and updates that can quietly pull time and energy away from ministry.

The Ministry Admin Support volunteer is a committee member who comes alongside the area director to lighten that load. Working mostly from home, on your own schedule, you help keep the calendar current, projects moving and communication flowing, often without anyone noticing, and that is exactly the point. Few roles free up more of an area director's time for what matters most.

Time commitment: 2–3 hours per week, almost entirely remote.

JOB DESCRIPTION

- **Manage the calendar.** Help maintain the area director's calendar and the area ministry calendar (club, Campaigners, camp, committee meetings and events), and help schedule meetings with donors, leaders and committee members.
- **Keep projects on schedule.** Track key deadlines and recurring projects, such as banquet prep, fall kickoff, camp and the annual plan, and give friendly nudges so nothing slips.
- **Support regional reporting.** Help gather and submit the reports and information the regional office requests, on time.
- **Send regular communication.** Draft and send updates to leaders, parents, committee members and donors on behalf of the area director, using the communication tools Young Life provides.
- **Find new ways to help.** As you learn the rhythms of the area, look for other places where you can take something off the area director's plate.

No one is expected to do all of this. The role is shaped around what helps our area director most and what fits the time you have.

Examples of Where You Might Help

- Tracking camp dates, registration deadlines, scholarship forms and payment reminders.
- Keeping a shared task list with the area director and following up on action items.
- Taking notes at committee meetings and following up on next steps.
- Turning the area director's bullet points into a polished newsletter or update.
- Maintaining contact lists for leaders, parents and committee members.
- Helping with expense receipts and reimbursements.
- Helping send donor thank-you notes.

Basic Strategies to Develop

- **Start with a training session.** Meet with the area director once to learn the calendar, key systems, recurring reports and communication tools. You will be given access to the Young Life systems you need.
- **Set a regular check-in.** A short weekly or biweekly call or meeting with the area director keeps priorities clear and makes your hours more effective. Occasional in-person time helps too.
- **Build a simple rhythm.** Keep a running list of recurring tasks and deadlines (weekly, monthly, seasonal) so the work becomes routine and easy to stay ahead of.
- **Grow the role over time.** As you get comfortable, suggest one or two new areas where you could help, and agree together on what fits your time.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Excellent organizational skills; enjoys keeping things on track.
- Possesses the gift of encouragement.
- Cheerful, positive and easy to work with.
- Comfortable serving behind the scenes.
- Learns quickly and is comfortable with email, calendars and online tools.
- Takes initiative and spots needs before being asked.
- Trustworthy with confidential information.

Ready to get involved?

Visit ylcommittee.com/boulder and click Get Involved. You can select one role or several, and our area director will reach out about next steps.